

An Act

ENROLLED HOUSE
BILL NO. 4317

By: Kendrix, Maynard and
Timmons of the House

and

Howard of the Senate

An Act relating to professions and occupations; amending 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.8, as last amended by Section 2, Chapter 192, O.S.L. 2025 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.8), which relates to qualifications to take an examination for accounting; modifying educational requirements; describing educational course requirements; amending 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.9, as last amended by Section 2, Chapter 192, O.S.L. 2025 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.9), which relates to issuing accounting certificates; deleting and modifying certain educational eligibility requirements to align with Uniform Accountancy Act; amending 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.12A, as last amended by Section 3, Chapter 26, O.S.L. 2023 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.12A), which relates to out-of-state licensed accounting business; deleting equivalency provision; providing pathway for in-state licensure; listing educational requirements; deleting out-of-state certificate or license exemption; amending 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.13, as last amended by Section 6, Chapter 26, O.S.L. 2025 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.13), which relates to public accounting certificates; modifying required documents for application; deleting and creating new conditions for applicants that do not meet certain requirements; and providing an effective date.

SUBJECT: Professions and occupations

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.8, as last amended by Section 2, Chapter 192, O.S.L. 2025 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.8), is amended to read as follows:

Section 15.8. A. A qualification applicant to qualify as a candidate for examination shall file an application for qualification in a format approved by the Oklahoma Accountancy Board. The fee for the qualification application shall be determined by the Board and shall not exceed Three Hundred Dollars (\$300.00). Every qualification applicant ~~to qualify as a candidate for the certificate of certified public accountant shall meet the education and experience requirements, except as otherwise provided in this section,~~ at the time of filing the application for qualification, shall meet the education requirements as provided in this section.

~~B. On or after November 1, 2025, every qualification applicant to qualify as a candidate for examination for the certificate of certified public accountant shall have at least one hundred twenty (120) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, of college education including a baccalaureate or higher degree, or the equivalent thereof, conferred by a college or university acceptable to the Board from an accredited four-year college or university in this state or any other accredited four-year college or university recognized by the Board. The total educational program of the applicant for examination shall include an accounting concentration or its equivalent as determined acceptable by the Board which shall include not less than twenty-four (24) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, in accounting courses above principles of accounting or introductory accounting, with at least one course in auditing or assurance; the remaining accounting courses shall be selected from financial accounting, accounting theory, cost/managerial accounting, federal income tax, governmental, not-for-profit accounting, accounting information systems, accounting history and other accounting electives; at least nine (9) semester hours shall be from any or all of the subjects of economics, statistics, business law, finance, business management, marketing, business communication, risk management, insurance, management information systems, or computer science at the upper-division level of college or above or the equivalent of such subjects as determined by the Board; all the remaining semester hours, if any, shall be elective.~~

~~C. The costs associated with the national criminal history record check shall be paid by the applicant.~~

B. On or after November 1, 2026, every qualification applicant to qualify as a candidate for examination for the certificate of certified public accountant shall have at least a baccalaureate or higher degree, or the equivalent thereof, conferred by a college or university acceptable to the Board from an accredited college or university in this state or any other accredited college or university recognized by the Board. The total educational program of the applicant to qualify for examination shall include an accounting concentration or its equivalent as determined acceptable by the Board, provided that the educational program shall include one of the following:

1. On or after November 1, 2026, and no later than May 31, 2030, not less than twenty-four (24) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, in accounting courses above principles of accounting or introductory accounting, with at least one course in auditing or assurance. The remaining accounting courses shall be selected from financial accounting, accounting theory, cost/managerial accounting, federal income tax, governmental and not-for-profit accounting, accounting information systems, accounting history, and other accounting electives. At least nine (9) semester hours shall be from any or all of the subjects of economics, statistics, business law, finance, business management, marketing, business communication, risk management, insurance, management information systems, or computer science at the upper-division level of college or above or the equivalent of such subjects as determined by the Board; all the remaining semester hours, if any, shall be elective; or

2. On or after November 1, 2026, not less than twenty-four (24) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, in accounting courses above principles of accounting or introductory accounting, with at least one course in auditing or assurance. The remaining accounting courses shall be selected from financial accounting, accounting theory, cost/managerial accounting, federal income tax, governmental and not-for-profit accounting, accounting information systems, accounting history, and other accounting electives. At least twenty-four (24) semester hours shall be from any or all of the subjects of economics, statistics, business law, finance, business management, marketing, business communication, risk management, insurance, management information systems, or computer science. All the remaining semester hours, if any, shall be elective.

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.9, as last amended by Section 2, Chapter 192, O.S.L. 2025 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.9), is amended to read as follows:

Section 15.9. A. Upon payment of appropriate fees, the Oklahoma Accountancy Board shall grant a certificate to any individual of good character who meets the applicable education, experience and testing requirements provided for in this section and in Sections 15.8 and 15.10 of this title. For purposes of this subsection, good character means an individual who does not have a history of dishonest acts as demonstrated by documented evidence and has not been convicted, pled guilty, or pled nolo contendere to a felony charge. The Board may refuse to grant a certificate to an applicant for failure to satisfy the requirement of good character. The Board shall provide to the denied applicant written notification specifying grounds for denial of a certificate including failure to meet the good character criterion. Appeal of the action of the Board may be made in accordance with the provisions of the Administrative Procedures Act.

B. The Board shall issue certificates as certified public accountants to those applicants who have met the qualifications required by the provisions of the Oklahoma Accountancy Act and the applicable rules of the Board, and have passed an examination in accounting, auditing and related subjects as the Board determines appropriate with such grades that satisfy the Board that each applicant is competent to practice as a certified public accountant.

C. The Board may make use of the Uniform Certified Public Accountant Examination and any organization that assists in providing the examination.

~~D. An applicant for initial issuance of a certificate pursuant to this section shall show that the applicant has at least one hundred fifty (150) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, of college education including a baccalaureate or higher degree, or the equivalent thereof, conferred by a college or university acceptable to the Board from an accredited four-year college or university in this state or any other accredited four-year college or university recognized by the Board. Of the one hundred fifty (150) semester hours, not less than thirty (30) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, shall be in accounting courses above principles of accounting or introductory accounting. These education requirements shall have been completed prior to submitting an application to the Board and within the time frame outlined in this section. A~~

~~qualified applicant may take the certified public accountant examination as allowed in Section 15.8 of this title but shall not be issued a certificate until the requirements pursuant to this section and Section 15.8 of this title have been met.~~

~~E. An applicant for initial issuance of a certificate under this section shall show that the applicant has had one (1) year of experience. Experience shall be defined by the Board by rule and shall include providing a type of service or advice involving the use of accounting, attest, compilation, management advisory, financial advisory, tax or consulting skills, and be satisfied through work experience in government, industry, academia or public practice, all of which shall be verified by a certificate or license holder or an individual approved by the Board. Upon completion of the requirements of Section 15.8 of this title, a qualified applicant for the examination may take the certified public accountant or public accountant examination prior to earning the experience required in this subsection, but shall not be issued a certificate until the experience requirement has been met.~~

E. A qualified applicant may take the Uniform Certified Public Accountant Examination but shall not be issued a certificate until the requirements pursuant to this section and Section 15.8 of this title have been met. An applicant for initial issuance of a certificate pursuant to this section shall show that the applicant has at least one of the following:

1. A post-baccalaureate degree conferred by a college or university acceptable to the Board, the total educational program to include an accounting concentration or equivalent as determined by Board rule; or

2. A baccalaureate degree plus an additional thirty (30) semester credit hours, conferred by an accredited college or university accepted by the Board, the total educational program to include an accounting concentration or equivalent as determined by Board rule; or

3. A baccalaureate degree conferred by an accredited college or university acceptable to the Board, the total educational program to include an accounting concentration or equivalent as determined by Board rule.

F. For purposes of subsection E of this section, the requirements of an accounting concentration or its equivalent shall

be determined by Board rule, provided that it shall include the following:

1. On or after November 1, 2026, and no later than May 31, 2030, not less than thirty (30) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, in accounting courses above principles of accounting or introductory accounting, with at least one course in auditing or assurance. The remaining accounting courses shall be selected from financial accounting, accounting theory, cost/managerial accounting, federal income tax, governmental and not-for-profit accounting, accounting information systems, accounting history, and other accounting electives. At least nine (9) semester hours shall be from any or all of the subjects of economics, statistics, business law, finance, business management, marketing, business communication, risk management, insurance, management information systems, or computer science at the upper-division level of college or above or the equivalent of such subjects as determined by the Board. All the remaining semester hours, if any, shall be elective; or

2. On or after November 1, 2026, not less than twenty-four (24) semester hours, or the equivalent thereof, in accounting courses above principles of accounting or introductory accounting, with at least one course in auditing or assurance. The remaining accounting courses shall be selected from financial accounting, accounting theory, cost/managerial accounting, federal income tax, governmental and not-for-profit accounting, accounting information systems, accounting history, and other accounting electives. At least twenty-four (24) semester hours shall be from any or all of the subjects of economics, statistics, business law, finance, business management, marketing, business communication, risk management, insurance, management information systems, or computer science. All the remaining semester hours, if any, shall be elective.

G. An applicant for initial issuance of a certificate under this section shall show that the applicant has the required experience as follows:

1. An applicant for initial issuance of a certificate under paragraphs 1 and 2 of subsection E of this section shall show that the applicant has had one (1) year of experience as defined by Board rule; or

2. An applicant for initial issuance of a certificate under paragraph 3 of subsection E of this section shall show that the

applicant has had two (2) years of experience as defined by Board rule.

~~F.~~ H. Every applicant for the certificate of certified public accountant shall provide evidence of successful completion of an ethics examination prescribed by the Board.

~~G.~~ I. Every applicant for the certificate of certified public accountant shall submit to a national criminal history record check in accordance with Section 150.9 of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes. Results of national criminal history record checks shall be provided to the Oklahoma Accountancy Board by the Oklahoma State Bureau of Investigation. Criminal history record check results are confidential and shall not be disseminated outside the Oklahoma Accountancy Board. The costs associated with the national criminal history record check shall be paid by the applicant.

~~H.~~ J. An individual applying for a certificate as a certified public accountant must make an application for the certificate within five (5) years of the date the Board notifies the candidate that the candidate has successfully passed all sections of the C.P.A. Examination. If the candidate fails to make an application for the certificate within five (5) years, the candidate must provide documentation showing he or she has completed at least one hundred twenty (120) hours of qualifying continuing public accountancy education completed within the three-year period immediately preceding the date the individual applies for certification. The Board shall establish rules whereby time limits set for application pursuant to this provision may, upon written application to the Board, be waived or reduced if the candidate is called to active military service or becomes incapacitated as a result of illness or injury or for such other good causes as determined by the Board on a case-by-case basis.

SECTION 3. AMENDATORY 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.12A, as last amended by Section 3, Chapter 26, O.S.L. 2023 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.12A), is amended to read as follows:

Section 15.12A. A. 1. An individual whose principal place of business is not in this state and who holds a valid certificate or license as a certified public accountant or public accountant from any jurisdiction ~~which the Oklahoma Accountancy Board's designee has verified to be in substantial equivalence to the certified public accountant and public accountant licensure requirements of the AICPA/NASBA Uniform Accountancy Act shall be presumed to have~~

~~qualifications substantially equivalent to this state's requirements~~
and shall have all the privileges of certificate and license holders of this state without the need to obtain a certificate, license or permit required under Sections 15.9, 15.13, and 15.14A, ~~15.15 and 15.15A~~ of this title, provided that the individual has passed the Uniform Certified Public Accountant Examination and that, at the time of initial licensure, the individual showed evidence of having met one of the following requirements:

- a. a post-baccalaureate degree with a concentration in accounting or an equivalent, and not less than one (1) year of work experience, both as defined in Board rule,
- b. a baccalaureate degree plus an additional thirty (30) semester credit hours with a concentration in accounting or an equivalent and not less than one (1) year of work experience, both as defined in Board rule, or
- c. a baccalaureate degree including an accounting concentration or an equivalent and not less than two (2) years of work experience, both as defined in Board rule.

An individual who offers or renders professional services, whether in person or by mail, telephone or electronic means, under this section shall be granted practice privileges in this state and no notice, fee or submission shall be provided by any such individual. Such an individual shall be subject to the requirements in paragraph 3 of this subsection.

2. An individual whose principal place of business is not in this state, who holds, and as of December 31, 2025, held a valid certificate or license as a certified public accountant or public accountant from any jurisdiction which the Oklahoma Accountancy Board's designee has not verified to be in substantial equivalence to the certified public accountant licensure requirements of the AICPA/NASBA Uniform Accountancy Act shall be presumed to have
~~qualifications substantially equivalent to this state's requirements and shall,~~ and who, and as of such date, had practice privileges in this state pursuant to this section, shall continue to have all the privileges of certificate and license holders of licensees in this state without the need to obtain a certificate, license or permit required under Sections 15.9, 15.13, and 15.14A, 15.15 and 15.15A of

this title. ~~Any individual who passed the Uniform CPA Examination and holds a valid certificate or license issued by any other state prior to January 1, 2012, may be exempt from the education requirement of the Uniform Accountancy Act for purposes of this paragraph.~~ An individual who offers or renders professional services, whether in person, or by mail, telephone or electronic means, under this section, shall be granted practice privileges in this state and no notice, fee or submission shall be provided by any such individual. Such an individual shall be subject to the requirements in paragraph 3 of this subsection.

3. An individual certificate holder or license holder of another jurisdiction exercising the privilege afforded under this section, and any firm which employs that certificate holder or license holder hereby simultaneously consent, as a condition of the granting of this privilege:

- a. to the personal and subject matter jurisdiction and disciplinary authority of the Board,
- b. to comply with the Oklahoma Accountancy Act and the Board's rules,
- c. that in the event the certificate holder or license holder from the jurisdiction of the individual's principal place of business is no longer valid, the individual will cease offering or rendering professional services in this state individually or on behalf of a firm, and
- d. to the appointment of the state board which issued the certificate or license as the agent upon whom process may be served in any action or proceeding by the Board against the certificate or license holder.

4. A certified public accounting or public accounting firm that is not subject to the requirements of paragraph 1 or 2 of subsection A of Section 15.15 of this title may perform services described in subsection 12 of Section 15.1A of this title and other nonattest professional services while using the title "CPA" or "CPA firm" in this state without a firm license, permit, or notice to the Board if the firm's practice in this state is performed by an individual who is licensed in Oklahoma or who has been granted practice privileges under paragraph 1 or 2 of this subsection, and the firm can lawfully

do so where the individuals with practice privileges have their principal place of business.

5. An individual who has been granted practice privileges under this section whose attest services described in paragraph 5 of Section 15.1A of this title may only do so through a firm which meets the requirements of paragraph 3 of subsection A of Section 15.15 of this title for exemption from the registration requirements or which has obtained a registration under Section 15.15 of this title and a permit issued under Section 15.15A of this title.

B. A registrant of this state offering or rendering services or using the registrant's CPA or PA title in another jurisdiction shall be subject to disciplinary action in this state for an act committed in another jurisdiction which would subject the certificate or license holder to discipline in that jurisdiction. The Board shall be required to investigate any complaint made by the board of accountancy of another jurisdiction.

SECTION 4. AMENDATORY 59 O.S. 2021, Section 15.13, as last amended by Section 6, Chapter 26, O.S.L. 2025 (59 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 15.13), is amended to read as follows:

Section 15.13. A. The Oklahoma Accountancy Board may issue a certificate to an applicant who has been authorized to practice public accounting as a certified public accountant pursuant to the laws of any jurisdiction if the applicant passed a test administered for the purpose of authorizing an individual to practice as a certified public accountant with grades which were equivalent to passing a test for the same purpose in this state as of the date the applicant originally passed the examination, and the applicant÷

~~1. Meets the requirements for issuance of a certificate in this state on the date of making application;~~

~~2. Met, on the date the certificate was issued by the other jurisdiction, the requirements in effect on that date for issuance of a certificate in this state; or~~

~~3. Met, on the date of becoming a candidate in another jurisdiction, the requirements of becoming a candidate in this state, except for residency~~

submits proof as provided by Board rule of completion of the licensure requirements of his or her original licensing jurisdiction

and passage of the Uniform Certified Public Accountant Examination, provided that the education and experience of the applicant would be considered substantially equivalent to the requirements for issuance of a certificate in this state.

B. In the event an applicant does not meet the requirements of subsection A of this section, ~~but has passed a test administered for the purpose of authorizing an individual to practice as a certified public accountant with grades which were equivalent to passing a test for the same purpose in this state on the date the applicant passed the examination, the Board may issue a certificate to an applicant if such applicant has four (4) years of experience practicing public accounting as a certified public accountant pursuant to the laws of any jurisdiction. Such experience must have occurred within the ten (10) years immediately preceding the application~~ the applicant shall show he or she:

1. Met, on the date the certificate was issued by the other jurisdiction, the requirements in effect on that date for issuance of a certificate in this state; or

2. Met, on the date of becoming a candidate in the other jurisdiction, the requirements of becoming a candidate in this state, except for residency; or

3. Passed the Uniform Certified Public Accountant Examination and attained four (4) years of experience practicing public accounting as a certified public accountant pursuant to the laws of any jurisdiction. Such experience shall have occurred within the ten (10) years immediately preceding the application.

Experience acceptable to satisfy the requirements of this subsection shall be determined by standards established by the Board.

C. An applicant who is seeking a permit to practice under this section must also provide satisfactory documentation to the Board that such applicant has met the continuing professional education requirements, as provided in Section 15.35 of this title, in effect on the date of the application.

D. The Board may issue a certificate by reciprocity to the extent required by treaties entered into by the government of the United States.

E. A fee in the amount equal to the registration fee and permit fee, if applicable, plus an administrative fee, the total of which shall not exceed Three Hundred Dollars (\$300.00), shall be paid by an applicant seeking a certificate pursuant to the provisions of this section. The total amount shall be established by Board rule.

F. On or after July 1, 2005, an applicant for the certificate of certified public accountant under this section shall provide evidence of successful completion of an ethics examination prescribed by the Board.

G. ~~As an alternative to the requirements of subsection A, B or C of this section, a~~ A certificate holder licensed by another jurisdiction who establishes the certificate holder's principal place of business in this state shall request the issuance of a certificate from the Board prior to establishing such principal place of business. The Board ~~shall~~ may issue a certificate to such person who obtains from the NASBA National Qualification Appraisal Service verification that such individual's CPA qualifications are substantially equivalent to the CPA licensure requirements of the AICPA/NASBA Uniform Accountancy Act.

H. An applicant for the certificate of certified public accountant under this section shall submit to a national criminal history record check in accordance with Section 150.9 of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes. Results of national criminal history record checks shall be provided to the Oklahoma Accountancy Board by the Oklahoma State Bureau of Investigation. Criminal history record check results are confidential and shall not be disseminated outside the Oklahoma Accountancy Board. The costs associated with the national criminal history record check shall be paid by the applicant.

SECTION 5. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

Passed the House of Representatives the 11th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the 29th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____